



MONTHLY UPDATE

Burkina Faso: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-18 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY
· CAPACITY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Two laws were voted and neither is promulgated. The legislative assembly [passed a data-protection law and an organic law merging the broadcasting regulator with the data-protection commission on 3 August](#), which would close two institutions and open one, and announced dedicated artificial-intelligence regulation to follow the national roadmap.

Enforcement went live first. Automated traffic enforcement [started at midnight on 1 August and detected 1,099 offences in its first twelve hours](#), collecting through the national payments platform — a working chain from detection to payment, running under a data-protection law that has not been promulgated. The cybersecurity estate is measured but unfunded: [205 public platforms were put through security testing under the critical-infrastructure programme](#), while the national computer emergency response team [has no appropriation in the 2024, 2025 or 2026 budget volumes](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Policy work this month was procedural rather than substantive. The digital transition ministry [held a CASEM session on what it contributes to the RELANCE 2026-2030 national plan](#). The plan text, the digital component, any budget line and any target are all unpublished, so what the record holds is that the process is running and not what it is expected to produce.

The other plan in hand is being redrawn rather than written: the authorities are [revising the national plan for the digital development of the territory to a 2030 horizon](#), against an international estimate putting about 70 per cent of the population off the internet in 2024. No revised text, timetable or cost is published.

Legislation and regulation

Civil status abroad got a new legal base: the Council of Ministers [adopted a decree on 10 September replacing the 1963 rules on diplomatic and consular civil-status powers and introducing mobile consular missions](#).

Data protection

On 3 August the legislature [voted the personal-data protection bill and the organic law creating a merged communications and data-protection authority](#). The new law prohibits and sanctions processing without consent, indexes administrative fines to turnover excluding tax and scales them by gravity, and prohibits transferring sensitive

data abroad. The merged authority takes the data-protection commission's mandate and is given its own rule-making power with artificial intelligence named specifically. Neither text is held, neither is promulgated, and no commencement, seat or leadership is stated.

Regional collaboration

The region's answer to a network that keeps being attacked is another country's fibre. At a meeting of the two digital ministers on 12 August, [Nigeria proposed connecting its planned 90,000 km open-access national fibre network to Burkina Faso's borders to improve internet resilience, quality and affordability, alongside cooperation on artificial intelligence, digital public infrastructure and talent](#). Both halves of that are prospective: the corridor is a proposal, and the Nigerian network it would reach is itself planned rather than built.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The same organic law creating the merged communications and data-protection authority folds the broadcasting regulator into it, transferring its mandate subject to promulgation; neither text is held and no commencement, seat or leadership is stated.

Finance

New investments

The regional development bank's Digital Transformation Fund [was presented to public administrations on 18 and 19 August, with its programme site and eligibility terms published](#). No allocation to this country, application window or committed amount is stated.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Coverage is to be bought in towers. A plan reported this month puts [800 towers up, 250 through the digital transformation acceleration project and 550 through the universal access and service fund, to connect 1,000 white-zone localities by 2027](#); the regulator's own figures put attacks on telecommunications infrastructure at 106 in 2022 against 11 in 2019, which is the condition the towers are going up in.

The state backbone's price became visible for the first time. Three years into operating the publicly built 3,000 km network, its operating company [put wholesale capacity at about FCFA 35 million a month for a 10 Gb service](#). It is one figure from the seller, with no retail pass-through and no comparison published.

The month's one new external route is a proposal rather than a link. Burkinabè and Nigerian digital ministries [met in Ouagadougou on 12 August to explore connecting Nigeria's planned 90,000km open-access fibre backbone into Burkina Faso](#), alongside cooperation on artificial intelligence in local languages, digital public infrastructure, cybersecurity and skills, and [a stated aim of halving internet costs through that backbone](#). No instrument was signed and the Nigerian backbone is itself unbuilt.

Data Storage

A wholly domestic commercial hosting provider [launched on 31 July](#) with more than 600 domain names, more than 196 web hostings and 98% availability at launch — the vendor's own figures, with capacity, tier and certification unstated.

The state's own cloud is in operation on the same sovereignty argument, its first two modular datacentres inaugurated at Ouagadougou under the zero-data-abroad programme to host and secure public data and to bring back data still held outside the country (cloud). The government publishes no capacity, operator or cost for it.

Energy

A 26.4 MW thermal plant was commissioned at Bobo 2 on 7 August, raising that site from 60 MW to 86.4 MW at over FCFA 33 billion financed entirely from national funds, presented as reducing supply interruptions. It follows a 50 MW plant seventeen days earlier. Neither is tied to a digital load: nothing states what any data centre or telecom site draws, and no interruption series is published against which either can be judged.

Cybersecurity

The Council of Ministers of 30 July adopted two decrees applying the 2024 information-systems security law: one identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, expressly spanning energy, water, health, telecommunications and finance, and one fixing periodic security audits and vesting auditor accreditation in the national cyberspace control body. The law had asserted both duties since July 2024 with no machinery attached.

The building meant to carry the supervision got its first progress statement in seven months. The digital transition minister inspected the site on 5 August, where the technical managers put physical execution across that worksite and the first citizen service centre together at about 20%; the stated delivery month is October 2026.

Alongside the build, the state published a count of what it has tested. 205 state digital platforms have been put through security testing to find and correct vulnerabilities, 1,460 platforms on the .bf domain reachable from the internet have been mapped, and 28 public bodies placed under reinforced protection, all under the national critical-infrastructure programme. No period, finding, remediation rate or list of the bodies covered accompanies the figures.

What the testing is against is now measured on two series that do not sit together. The cybercrime unit puts reported loss at about FCFA 1.7bn in 2025 and FCFA 906,123,245 in the first half of 2026 on more than a thousand complaints in that half year, while an August account of the same unit's figures gives 6,367 complaints and FCFA 1.872bn of losses for 2025. The unit also equipped an audiovisual studio to produce educational content on digital risks, with deconstructing false information central to its remit.

DPI

Data Exchange

Two states that share a river proposed sharing the data that would stop it drowning people. Burkinabe and Ghanaian officials proposed a formal reservoir release protocol built on real-time data sharing and pre-agreed spill thresholds, and heard the Burkinabe power utility's chief hydrologist disclose that letters seeking closer coordination with the Ghanaian river authority, sent as far back as October 2025, had gone unanswered. Working groups mapped why warnings fail on the shared river: messages move too slowly, district assemblies lack transport and fuel, agencies holding forecast data do not always talk to disaster responders, and repeated false alarms have bred complacency. The proposal is a research project's rather than either government's, and nothing is signed.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The Sahel alliance's shared credential reached another town. Enrolment for the common biometric identity card opened in Arbinda on 27 August. Arbinda is in the Soum province, which makes where enrolment opens a security question as much as an administrative one. The record held carries no enrolment total for the card, in Burkina Faso or across the alliance.

Enrolment then reached the capital under pressure of demand. The identification office [opened nine further sites across Ouagadougou — police stations, arrondissement offices and a cultural centre — and set delivery at 48 hours for a special operation running to 16 September](#), and ran special enrolment operations across every region for the seventh International Identity Day. No enrolment count accompanies either.

The day itself named the identity chain's next use. The security minister made [the securing of academic and professional diplomas the theme of the commemoration, setting the aim as a centralised national interoperability and trust framework that leaves academic prerogatives with the institutions while making the production and verification chain tamper-proof](#). No instrument, operator or timetable is published for it.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The payments rail acquired a new obligation rather than new users: it [became the collection channel for automated traffic fines from 1 August](#), carrying payment links served with the fine and vehicle immobilisation for non-payment within a month.

Certified electronic invoicing moved from rule to product. The tax administration announced that [certified invoicing systems go on sale from 7 September 2026](#), under the 2025 order that established the certified invoice. No price, supplier list or take-up figure is published.

Registries

Civil registration is being digitised one commune at a time, and the training is the visible part. Delegated officers and transcribing agents in Pouni [were trained over 72 hours from 31 August to 2 September on smartphone configuration and real-time entry of births, marriages and deaths at central and secondary registration offices](#), funded under a regional local-governance project in the 2026 budget year. Thirty communes hold fully digitised registers; no count of officers trained or acts entered through the platform is published.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Automated traffic enforcement entered operation at midnight on 1 August after an April pilot, reading plates against the vehicle database, serving fines by message with a link to the national payments rail, and immobilising vehicles for non-payment within a month. It [logged 1,099 offences between midnight and noon that day](#) and five payments. Neither held account reports a legal basis, retention rule or data-protection authorisation; [the justification given is 15,614 road accidents in 2025](#).

The system's first month is measured, and the gap is collection. [19,910 offences were recorded between 1 and 31 August 2026, generating CFA146.559m in fines, of which CFA16.1m had been recovered at the review of 4 September](#). The state's answer is a body rather than a system: a [motorised police brigade created on 2 September specifically to trace drivers who evade the camera-issued fines](#). Barely a ninth of the month's fines were collected, and no appeal, error or contested-notice figure is published — which is what a reader would need to tell non-payment from wrongly-issued notices.

The health ministry's accreditation portal, launched on 7 August, arrived with the one thing most of these launches lack — a use figure. It had taken [more than 247 applications since a soft launch in April 2026, of which 39 were validated](#) by the day of the official launch. The counts are the ministry's own, and the record does not explain the gap between the two.

The foreign ministry put three platforms up on 19 August: a diaspora registration and consular-appointment portal, a system for diplomatic cards, and a consolidated site for the ministry and its 52 missions. The asset recovery agency opened another on 3 September, letting people who bought plots or buildings from three court-seized property companies register their claims remotely and upload scanned identity and title documents. Neither carries a use figure.

Automation also failed publicly for the first time. The civil service ministry admitted that part of one examination centre's scanned scripts were not carried over at the transfer to the marking machines in the 2026 recruitment competitions, affecting results published on 25 August, and that re-marking added candidates to the successful lists. It is the one account on file of a digitised process being checked against its own output.

Electronic signature then arrived on its announced date. FasoSign was launched on 15 September already integrated into the mission-order, administrative-mail and cadastre platforms, its keys and certificates presented as held by the state itself; no signature count or adoption list is published. At the same council the Prime Minister named weak citizen uptake of the digital service platforms as a persistent shortcoming, without a figure for it.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Citizen service centres stand at two pilot sites under construction, with architectural studies under way for a further city, eight regional capitals and fifty rural communes, against a state and postal-service contract for twenty spaces over five years. No unit cost and no beneficiary count is published. The first of the pilots now has a name, Zama Tchey, and was inspected on 5 August; it is to bring postal, financial and digital services closer to the population. A second inspection two days later put the first Maison du citoyen at 20% complete, one of twelve structuring digitalisation projects the ministry names, and took in the national fibre backbone's network operations centre on the same visit.

Technology

AI

Automated enforcement produced the month's only measurement of a system deciding for itself: 1,099 offences detected in the first twelve hours of operation, with no accuracy, contest route or false-positive figure beside it.

Asked in plenary where artificial intelligence sat in the new data-protection law, the justice minister said it was already integrated through the ban on transferring sensitive data abroad, with the national roadmap to become dedicated regulation later. No draft, timetable or scope for that regulation is on file.

Innovation ecosystem

The first Sahel Tech Innovation Challenge closed in Ouagadougou, taking 600 submitted projects from 23 African countries down to 100, then 60, then 10 finalists. First prize went to a Burkinabe agricultural artificial-intelligence tool built to work in national languages. No prize value, follow-on funding or second edition is announced.

The national digital event returns in October: a second edition running from 17 to 24 October, wholly online, with Rwanda as guest of honour and 95 entries taken in its innovation competition by 16 September. A third operator digital centre also opened at a regional university on 31 July, against a hub count the repository still holds only from a 2019 continental study.

Capacity

Training and skills

The one training development in the window is small and specific. An association of blind and partially sighted students [closed its fifth adapted computing course on 11 September, having trained 70 visually impaired pupils and students](#) from first computer use to e-mail and AI, and its president said they have no computers to practise on afterwards.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute [announced a national statistical innovation observatory at the statistics council's session of 11 September, using satellite imagery, mobile-phone, web and weather data and artificial intelligence to produce indicators for all 351 communes within days](#). The same session reviewed a [draft 2027 statistical programme costed at CFA 10.6 billion, 52.7% of it state-financed](#). No timetable for the observatory and no data-access agreement with mobile operators is stated.

Open data

The finance ministry cited [a 2025 Open Data Inventory score of 77 out of 100, first in West Africa and second in Africa](#). The inventory scores official statistics published online; the national open-data portal founded in 2015 still serves no catalogue.

Geopolitics

China activities

The month's only Chinese item is an approach rather than an agreement: the communications minister and a Burkinabe delegation were [received at a Chinese broadcaster's Beijing headquarters on 22 August 2026 to examine partnership in audiovisual and digital broadcasting, the exchanges going to the terms of collaboration with the national broadcaster and the national transmission company](#). No memorandum, commitment, value or timetable is stated.

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